The question of Israel's future has been a fixation for Western commentators in recent years, particularly Jewish ones. The American journalist Peter Beinart brought the subject into the mainstream in 2012 with his book *The Crisis of Zionism*, which argued that the ongoing occupation, now past its fiftieth anniversary, threatens Israeli democracy and alienates American Jews from Israel.

The events of the subsequent few years, particularly the outcomes of two elections and the devastating Gaza war in the summer of 2014, brought a sense of urgency to this discussion. Jonathan Freedland, a leading columnist for Britain's liberal newspaper *The Guardian*, wrote that there was still hope, with liberal Zionists "better placed than most to move Zionist, including Israeli, opinion."[1] Antony Lerman, another British writer, thought the liberal Zionist movement was already past its sell-by date. He instead urged well-meaning leftists to push for "a movement to achieve equal rights and self-determination for all in Israel-Palestine", beyond the tired and failed efforts for a two-state solution.[2] There was also Roger Cohen, the *New York Times* columnist, who visited Israel before the 2015 election and concluded that the Zionist Camp (the main center-left party) represented the last chance to stave off a looming binational catastrophe:

> A battle has been engaged for Israel's soul… the two-state idea is alive but ever more tenuous. It is compatible with an Israel true to its founding principles. It is incompatible with an Israel bent on Jewish supremacy and annexation of all or most of the land between the Mediterranean Sea and the Jordan River. It can be resurrected, because there is no plausible alternative, despite the fact that almost a half-century of dominion over another people has produced ever greater damage, distrust and division. It can be buried only at the expense of Israel as a Jewish and democratic state, for no democracy can indefinitely control the lives of millions of disenfranchised people—and that is what many Palestinians are.[3]

Days before the election, Beinart also warned Israeli voters that reinstalling Netanyahu would irreparably damage their relationship with the US. The message obviously fell on deaf ears:

> Bibi is putting Israel on an ideological collision course with the people who will likely dominate American politics in the years to come. He's alienating the young and non-white voters who backed Obama not merely because he's treated Obama with disrespect but, more fundamentally, because he flouts the values that led them to support Obama in the first place.[4]

The main source of their angst is the Israeli occupation of the West Bank, East Jerusalem and the Gaza Strip. The average diaspora Jew is a liberal. "There are more than twice as many self-identified Jewish liberals as